AtiNAMatiC-Boost — User Manual

Version 0.2.0 Atij 666 Studio — Designed & developed by Atij

What's new in v0.2.0

- **Constant loudness, clean at 0 %.** BOOST now stays within about ±1 dB across the whole sweep (it used to drop ~3 dB and lose ~10 dB of peak level at PUSH, and add +1.8 dB at 0 %). At CLEAN the curve is effectively linear.
- **4× oversampling** on the saturation stage removes the harsh aliasing that a following amp sim would otherwise amplify. This adds **38 samples** of latency (≈0.8 ms at 48 kHz), reported to your DAW for automatic compensation; the dry path of MIX is delay-matched.
- DC from the asymmetric (2nd-harmonic) bias is now removed, so there are no low-frequency thumps on note attacks.
- **New interface** — machined knob with a printed 0–10 scale, hardware-style mode switches that follow automation and preset recall, consistent value text ("72 %", "+1.5 dB"), resizable window (75–150 %, remembered per session). Double-click any knob to reset it; hold **Shift** while dragging for fine adjustment.

Overview

AtiNAMatiC-Boost adds life, punch, and harmonic clarity to any signal — designed to sit **before** your NAM amp sim (it is voiced to feed an amp model), though it also works anywhere you want musical saturation and presence.

Unlike a simple booster, it uses a three-stage soft-saturation engine with character modes and parallel mix control, so you can push the tone without destroying your dynamics.

System Requirements

	Minimum
OS	Windows 10 (64-bit) · macOS 10.15+ · Linux (Ubuntu 20.04+)
CPU	Any modern 64-bit processor
RAM	256 MB
Formats	Standalone · VST3 · CLAP · AU (macOS)
DAW	Any VST3 or CLAP host

Installation

Windows — Using the Installer (Recommended)

Run **AtiNAMatiC-Boost-v0.2.0-Setup.exe** and follow the on-screen steps.

The installer places files at:

Format	Location
Standalone	`C:\Program Files\Atij666Studio\AtiNAMatiC-Boost\`
VST3	`C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3\`
CLAP	`C:\Program Files\Common Files\CLAP\`

After installation, rescan plugins in your DAW.

> **Antivirus notice:** Windows may show a SmartScreen or antivirus popup on first run because the binary is not yet widely known. The software is safe — click *More info → Run anyway* (SmartScreen) or *Allow / Trust* in your AV. This warning disappears as more users install the plugin and its reputation builds.

Windows — Manual Installation (No Installer)

If you prefer not to use the installer, copy the files yourself — no extra files or dependencies are needed.

Step 1 — Copy your desired formats:

File	Copy to
`AtiNAMatiC-Boost.exe`	Anywhere (e.g. `C:\Program Files\Atij666Studio\AtiNAMatiC-Boost\`)
`AtiNAMatiC-Boost.vst3` *(folder)*	`C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3\`
`AtiNAMatiC-Boost.clap`	`C:\Program Files\Common Files\CLAP\`

> **Important:** The `.vst3` is a **folder**, not a single file. Copy the entire folder (including its `Contents\` subdirectory) into the VST3 directory.

Step 2 — Rescan in your DAW After copying, open your DAW and trigger a plugin rescan. The exact option varies by DAW: - **Reaper:** Options → Preferences → Plug-ins → VST → Re-scan - **Bitwig:** Settings → Plug-ins → Rescan - **Ableton Live:** Preferences → Plug-Ins → Rescan - **FL Studio:** Options → Manage plugins → Refresh

To uninstall manually: delete the copied files from the paths above.

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macOS

Mount the **.dmg**, drag the components to the indicated folders, then rescan in your DAW.

Format	Location
Standalone	`/Applications/`
VST3	`/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3/`
AU	`/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components/`
CLAP	`/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/CLAP/`

Linux

Run `./build-linux.sh` from the project root. Plugins are installed to `~/.vst3/` and `~/.clap/`.

Controls Reference



BOOST

Controls the drive into the saturation engine. Higher values push more harmonic content and add musical compression. The Spark Pill indicator shows the current harmonic activity level.

Range	Character
0 – 20 %	Transparent gain, subtle warmth
20 – 50 %	Natural harmonic enhancement — sweet spot for most signals
50 – 80 %	Noticeable saturation, aggressive presence
80 – 100 %	Heavy push, leads and solos

CHARACTER

Selects the tonal focus of the saturation engine:

Mode	Description
BALANCED	Flat character — enhances presence evenly across the spectrum
BRIGHT	High-frequency clarity shelf — adds edge and definition, ideal for single-coil pickups and clean tones
THICK	Low-mid weight shelf — fattens humbuckers and palm-muted riffs

MIX

Parallel blend between the dry signal (0 %) and fully processed signal (100 %). Use lower values (20–50 %) for New York–style parallel saturation — adds harmonic density while preserving the attack transients of the dry signal.

OUTPUT

Final output trim gain, range **−24 to +12 dB**. Use it to match perceived loudness after boosting, or to drive the next stage harder.

Activity Meter

Shows real-time input (top) and output (bottom) levels from **−60 to 0 dB**. The output band colour shifts toward the accent colour as harmonic content increases — giving a visual read of how hard the saturation is working.

Spark Pill

A harmonic activity indicator in the top-right of the meter section:

Label	Harmonic Amount
CLEAN	0 – 10 % — minimal saturation
LIFT	10 – 45 % — light harmonic enhancement
ALIVE	45 – 75 % — moderate saturation
PUSH	75 – 100 % — heavy drive

Signal Chain (Under the Hood)

```
Input
  → High-pass filter (35 Hz)     removes sub-bass mud before saturation
  → Clean gain stage             scales signal into saturation range
  → Tanh soft-clipping           adds even-order harmonics
  → 2nd-harmonic bias            warms the saturation character
  → Clarity / Mode shelf EQ      shapes tonal character (per MODE)
  → Auto make-up gain            compensates loudness
  → Output trim                  user-controlled OUTPUT knob
  → Dry/Wet blend                MIX knob
Output
```

Typical Use Cases

After a NAM amp sim

Place AtiNAMatiC-Boost on the channel after your Neural Amp Modeler. Use **BALANCED** mode at **40–60 % BOOST**, **MIX 100 %**, and trim OUTPUT to match the unprocessed loudness. This adds the "pushed amp" feel that neural captures sometimes lack.

Parallel saturation bus

Send multiple tracks to an auxiliary. Insert AtiNAMatiC-Boost with **MIX 20–40 %** and **BOOST 70 %** in **THICK** mode. Blend back to taste — adds glue and warmth without thickening transients.

Lead guitar presence boost

Use **BRIGHT** mode with **BOOST 60–80 %** and **MIX 60 %**. Keeps the dry attack while adding harmonic cut-through. Reduce OUTPUT by 2–4 dB to compensate loudness before automation.

Drum bus punch

BALANCED mode, **BOOST 30 %**, **MIX 30–50 %**. Adds body and snap without obvious saturation. Especially effective on room mics or overheads.

Tips

- The **35 Hz high-pass filter** is always active — this is intentional. Sub-bass energy in the saturation stage creates intermodulation distortion; removing it keeps the low end clean.
- Use **BOOST + low MIX** rather than **low BOOST + full MIX** when you want subtle enhancement — pushing the saturation stage harder and blending less gives richer harmonics at equal perceived loudness.
- For A/B comparison, set **MIX to 0 %** and trim **OUTPUT** until loudness matches, then gradually raise MIX.

About

AtiNAMatiC-Boost v0.2.0 Atij 666 Studio Designed & developed by Atij

Built with: - JUCE Framework — Raw Material Software Ltd. - VST3 SDK — Steinberg Media Technologies GmbH - CLAP SDK — Free Audio / clap-juce-extensions - Neural Amp Modeler (NAM) — Steven Atkinson & contributors - The open-source audio & guitar-plugin community

Thank you to everyone who makes open-source audio tools possible.

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